The Eastern and Western Dedicated Freight Corridors (DFC) are a mega rail transport project being undertaken to increase transportation capacity, reduce unit costs of transportation, and improve service quality –

- The Eastern DFC (1839 route kilometres [RKM]) extends from Dankuni near Kolkata to Ludhiana in Punjab, while the Western DFC (1499 RKM) extends from the Jawahar Lal Nehru Port (JNPT) in Mumbai to Dadri /Rewari near Delhi.
- A special purpose vehicle, the *Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited* has been set up to implement the project. Out of 10,703 ha of land to be acquired for the project, 7,768 ha (73 per cent) has already been awarded under the Railway Amendment Act (RAA) 2008.
- The Eastern and Western DFC projects are being *funded* through a mix of bilateral/multilateral loans, gross budgetary support (GBS), and PPP. The Western DFC is being funded by the Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA) up to 77 per cent of the total cost.
- The Ludhiana to Mughalsarai section (1183 km) of the Eastern DFC is being funded by the World Bank up to 66 per cent of the project cost.
- The Mughalsarai-Sonnagar sector (122 km) will be funded by Indian Railways' own resources.Civil construction work of this sector is in progress.
- The Dankuni-Sonnagar section (534 km) of the Eastern DFC to be funded through PPP mode.
- After commissioning of the Eastern and Western DFCs, it is planned to upgrade the speed of passenger trains to 160-200 kmph on the existing routes. A feasibility study for upgradation of speed of passenger trains to 160-200 kmph on the existing Delhi-Mumbai route has been undertaken with co-operation from the Government of Japan in 2012-13.

Apart from the Eastern and Western DFCs, a feasibility study has also been undertaken on four ***future*** freight corridors, viz. East-West Corridor (Kolkata-Mumbai), North-South Corridor (Delhi-Chennai), East Coast